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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Divide marks DC riot’s anniversary

White House recasts Jan. 6 events; Dems push to remember

By **Lisa Mascaro**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Five years ago outside the White House, outgoing President Donald Trump told a crowd of supporters to head to the Capitol — “and I’ll be there with you” — in protest as Congress was affirming the 2020 election victory for Democrat Joe Biden.

A short time later, the world watched as the seat of U.S. power descended into chaos, and democracy hung in the balance.

On the fifth anniversary of Jan. 6, 2021, there was no official event to memorialize what happened that day, when the mob made its way down Pennsylvania Avenue, battled police at the Capitol barricades and stormed inside,

as lawmakers fled. The political parties refuse to agree to a shared history of the events, which were broadcast around the globe. And the official plaque honoring the police who defended the Capitol has never been hung.

Instead, the day displayed the divisions that still define Washington, and the country. The administration itself issued a report on a

new page of the White House web site with its own revised history of what happened.

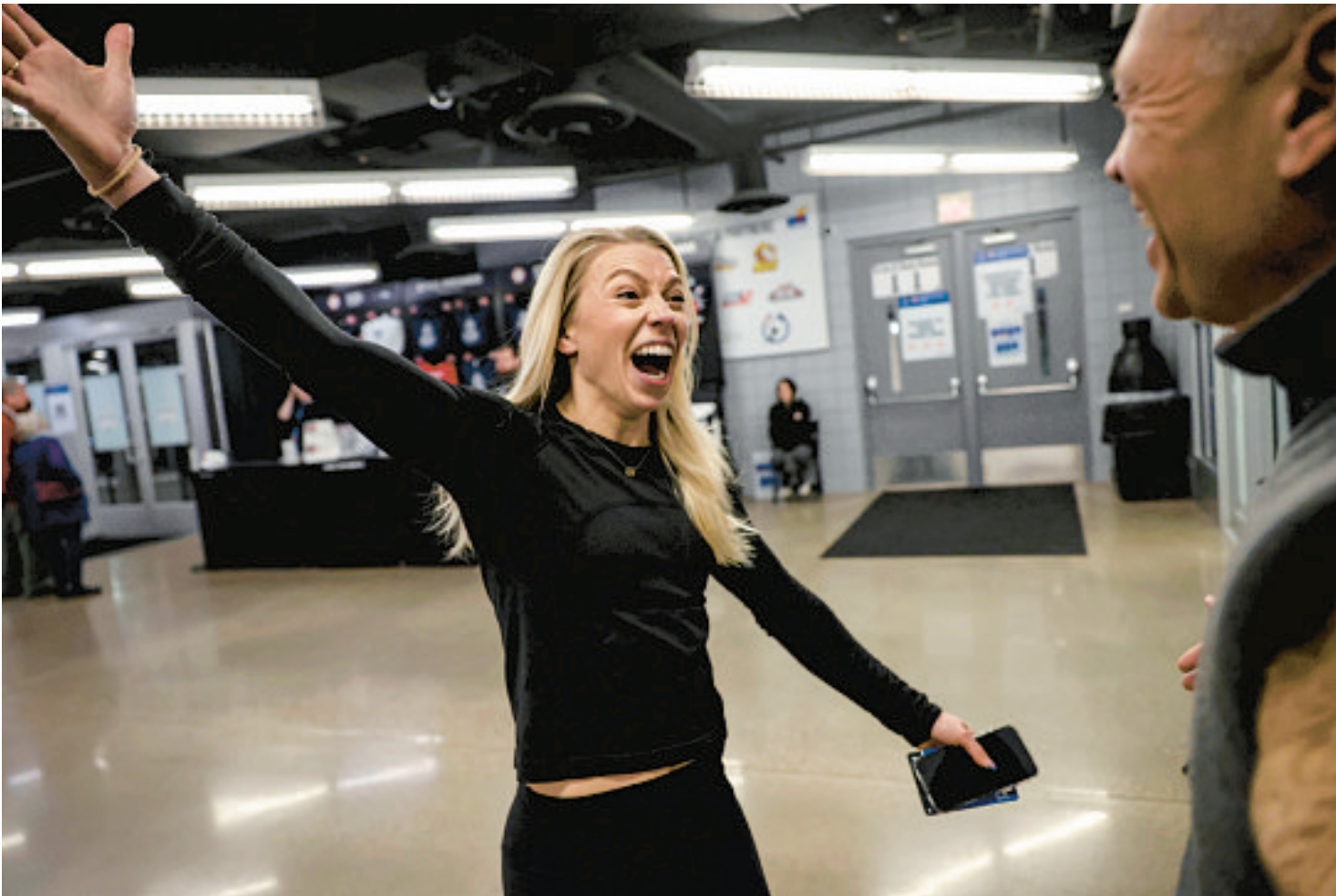
The site blames Capitol Police officers, who defended lawmakers that day, for starting the assault; Democrats, who were the rioters’ main targets, for failing to prevent it; and former Vice President Mike Pence, who rejected falsehoods about the 2020 election, for allowing the results to be certified.

Trump, during a lengthy morning speech to House Republicans

convening away from the Capitol at the rebranded Kennedy Center now carrying his own name, shifted blame for Jan. 6 onto the rioters themselves.

The president said he had intended only for his supporters to go “peacefully and patriotically” to confront Congress as it certified Biden’s win. He blamed the media for focusing on other parts of his speech that day.

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Sarah Warren hugs her father, Morrison Warren, as she celebrates making her first Olympics by finishing second in the women's 500-meter event on Monday during the U.S. Olympic Team Trials Long Track at the Pettit National Ice Center in Milwaukee. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘I DREAMED OF THIS SINCE I WAS A LITTLE GIRL’

After torn ACLs and 10 surgeries, Chicago’s Sarah Warren qualifies for the Olympics in speedskating

By **Andrew Carter** | Chicago Tribune

MILWAUKEE — Cathy Connelly-Warren spent parts of a long Sunday night in Wisconsin awake and unable to sleep, staring at the wall in her hotel room “thinking of speeches,” she said. The “good speech,” as she put it, promised to be easy. If her daughter qualified for the U.S. Olympic Team in speedskating, the moment would speak for itself.

But what if she didn’t? What if there was more heartbreak after so much of it? What to say then?

Connelly-Warren arrived at the Pettit National Ice Center on Monday prepared for both outcomes on the final day of Olympic trials in long track. She and her family gathered along the edge of the ice and near the finish line, hearts pounding. The starting gun fired. Sarah Warren, who had been dreaming of the Olympics for almost 20 years, burst into a furious sprint.

Five hundred meters and a little more than 38 seconds later, she crossed the finish line, pumped her fists and released a celebratory scream. She cried. The first person she hugged was her mom and they held each other in an emotional embrace. After torn ACLs in both of her knees, 10 surgeries and countless rejections of those who told her it might be time to quit, Sarah Warren had done it.

She’d qualified for the Olympics. She’d made Team USA. She’s off to Milan next month.

Few American Olympians — or those anywhere else — will have endured as long and difficult a journey to Italy. In the past year alone, the 29-year-old Warren, who grew up in Willowbrook and attended Hinsdale South High School, underwent four surgeries: three on her knees and one on an ankle. She never quite felt back to full strength, she said, not even on Monday — not that she could feel anything other than elation after one of the longest days of her life.

“You envision the moment your

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Cannabis syndrome now more common

Screaming + vomiting: ‘Scromiting’ rare, but cases rose from ’16-’22

By **Robert McCoppin**
Chicago Tribune

Like many cannabis smokers, Jared Panks used marijuana as medicine. As a paramedic, he’d seen the disastrous effects of other drugs and alcohol so, after years of fighting forest fires, he began to smoke marijuana to dull the pain in his torn-up knees.

He became more interested in the plant’s potential benefits after seeing family members suffer from cancer and opioid abuse. Panks co-founded HomeGrown ORegonicX, a medical cannabis cultivation company in Oregon, and started smoking pot frequently every day to test different strains.

He was shocked in 2013 when he was struck by vicious bouts of vomiting. He would start vomiting in the morning and continue the rest of the day non-stop, sometimes for days at a time. He couldn’t eat or keep down fluids. Only a hot shower would offer some relief. The condition would fade, reemerge after two or three months, often at times of stress, such as before his marriage or when his father died.

Panks lost 50 pounds as his body seemed to be trying to purge something. His abdominal muscles ached from constant dry heaves. His throat was burned by the stomach acids, and a dentist told him his teeth were ruined.

When a doctor gave him his diagnosis, he initially refused to believe it: cannabinoid hyperemesis syndrome, or CHS. Often accompanied by the anguished cries of its victims, it’s also known by another name: scromiting, for the combination of screaming and vomiting.

“Sometimes it goes 14 days, where my whole body starts to seize up,” Panks said. “I have to go to the ER and get fluids. It can be very, very brutal. You’re crawling up the stairs because you don’t

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INSIDE



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

‘Just really focused at the task at hand’

The Bears are preparing for an intense atmosphere in Saturday’s playoff opener — on the field and in the stands. **Chicago Sports**

Top lawyer calls deaths ‘war crime’

At least 24 Venezuelan security officers were killed in the U.S. military operation to capture Nicolas Maduro. **Nation & World**

‘Cat’ Sharp exits Cook County Board race

‘Broadview Six’ prosecution claims a political casualty

By **A.D. Quig**
Chicago Tribune

The high-profile prosecution of six people charged in connection with their protests outside the Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview claimed its first political victim as one of the six — a candidate for Cook County Board — has dropped out of her race for office.

Catherine “Cat” Sharp, one of the so-called Broadview Six, announced late Monday she was no longer running for the County Board seat because she needed to “focus on winning the legal

battle against the Trump administration.”

“Navigating this unimaginable legal process and all the costs — emotional and financial — that come with it, have made running for office much more difficult,” Sharp wrote in a post on X. “When I launched this campaign for the Cook County Board back in the summer, I said I was running because we need principled, bold leadership at the local level at a time when our communities are under attack from the federal government. I had no idea how true that statement would prove to be over the last several months.”

Sharp’s political decision came hours before more than 50 Border Patrol agents arrived

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Then-Cook County Board candidate Catherine “Cat” Sharp rallies with supporters before a hearing for her and other indicted “Broadview Six” immigration protesters on Nov. 12, 2025, at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

